

The 3 types of accounts



Covered in this lecture:

The 3 types of accounts you see on Instagram

▶ **#1 Business account**

- it represents your business
- it has your business name
- you use it to keep people engaged with whatever your company is doing

▶ **#2 Personal account**

- it promotes you and whatever you are doing
- you use it to keep in touch with your followers

▶ **#3 Themed account**

- it covers a specific theme and delivers content that matches that theme
- ex.: motivation, tips and tricks, cats, travel, technology, etc.
- you can use it to push attention to your business

What goes into a great account & jargon



Covered in this lecture:

The pieces that make up your account

▶ **#1 Profile picture**

- it's your logo or a photo of yourself

▶ **#2 Username**

- the name that shows up at the top of your account, it's what you'll be known as

▶ **#3 Account name**

- it's like a subtitle, it shows up under your username on your profile and in search results

▶ **#4 Bio**

- it's the 2-3 lines where you describe what your account is about and why people should follow you

▶ **#5 Call to action**

- it's the last line of the bio that tries to convince people to click the link below it

- The area of the page where your photos/videos show up is called the wall/feed/gallery

Picking a name



Covered in this lecture:

How to pick a good name for your account

- ▶ Everything on Instagram is changeable - whatever you pick, you can change it later
- ▶ **Your username:**
 - it shows up at the top of your account
 - it's what people type in if they want to find you
 - it shows up anytime you post/add a comment
- ▶ How to check if a username is available:
 - #1 Go to namecheckr.com
 - #2 When you try to sign up, a red x will show up if the username is not available, or a green tick if it is available
- **Business accounts:**
 - get a name that's closest to your actual business name
 - people need to be able to find you
- ▶ If your brand name is not available, try a variation of your name:
 - add .com at the end of your name
 - add insta or instagram to your name

- add your location to your name
- add your niche to your name

● **Personal accounts:**

- try to get your actual name
- ▶ If your name is not available:
 - add .com if you also have a website/blog with your name
 - add a positive adjective: expert, master, etc.
 - summarize yourself in the most succinct way possible

● **Themed accounts:**

- pick a name that tells people what they will get if they follow you
- ▶ The best accounts have a name that alliterates or rhymes (ex.: cutecupcakes)

Naming pro tips



Covered in this lecture:

Dos and don'ts of naming your account

▶ **DO:**

- Think about who are the biggest brands in your space
- See if you can use their name in your name
- If someone searches for them, you can pop up as well
- Be careful about copyright issues though
- Keep it simple so it's easy to remember

▶ **DON'T:**

- Try not to use a name that is already used in multiple variations and they're active accounts - if they're bigger than you, people will most likely follow them instead of you
- Don't put numbers at the end of your name
- Don't use underscores or periods in your name
- Don't use special characters - Instagram can't display those anyway
- Don't use repeating letters just because you can't get the normal word

Name vs username



Covered in this lecture:

The difference between name and username

- ▶ **The username has to work on an URL - you can't have spaces in it and it has to stay lowercase**
- ▶ When you search on Instagram, the usernames show up first, and the names just look like subtitles
- ▶ **The name is usually a short summary of what your account is about**
- ▶ Think about what keywords you would like to show up for, and what keywords your audience might be searching for
- ▶ Use ranksonic.com to get some relevant keywords
- **Don't put the same name and username - you're wasting search space**
- ▶ In order to choose a name, answer these questions:
 - how would you summarize what your account is?
 - what do you want people to think about you?
 - what do you do on your page?
 - what's the 1-2 punch that would get people to check out your account?

What goes into a good logo



Covered in this lecture:

How to pick your logo

- ▶ Your profile photo sets the stage for your account, so put some effort into it
- ▶ Where people see your profile photo:
 - Profile page on mobile - 110x110 pixels
 - Profile page on web - 180x180 pixels
 - As a thumbnail next to your comments
- ▶ Add a higher resolution photo so it looks good on both mobile and web
- ▶ Even if the Instagram profile photos look like a circle, you need to upload a square image
- **Company or brand: put your logo**
 - Use the symbol of your logo and not the text
 - If you don't have a symbol, use your logotype
 - Use the background of the image or the circle outline of the profile photo to stand out
 - You can use the inverse of your logo

- **Personal account: put a photo of your face**

- Your face conveys your personality way more than your body
- Make sure you have a high resolution professional headshot
- Make sure your photo doesn't have a lot of noise in the background - use a plain background

- **Themed account: put a logo or the best photo you have from your content**

- Make something colorful so it stands out

Getting design done for your profile picture



Covered in this lecture:

How to get a nice profile photo

● **Personal accounts: photo of your face/headshot**

#1 Find a friend with a DSLR

#2 Hire someone to take your photograph

#3 Rent a nice camera - thumbtack.com, craigslist.com

#4 Go to a place where they take your photo on the spot

● **Themed accounts: logo**

#1 Do it yourself; take the text from your name and try to stylize that

#2 Hire a logo designer: fiverr.com, 99designs.com, etc.

#3 Shapefactory.co - get a basic logo from their database (cheaper than a designer)

What goes into a good bio



Covered in this lecture:

Types of bios and using emojis

- ▶ Your bio is the text you see below your account name
- ▶ The bio is the link between your account name and your call to action (CTA)
- ▶ When people land on your page, they first look at your profile picture, then at the account name, then at the link, and then they check out your posts
- **Main types of bios:**
 - #1 One-two bio - it has two sentences: 1) explains what you are, 2) explains why you matter
 - #2 List bio - it lists out 2-4 things in a checklist style; it visually stands out
- ▶ List bios force people to read them because they push down the posts, one-two bios are usually a sign that you can skip them and check out the posts
- ▶ Use emojis in your bio to give your profile some life and make it stand out
- ▶ Instagram's vibe is open, friendly, and fun; don't put too many emojis, but not too few either

What you should say in your bio



Covered in this lecture:

The content of your bio

- ▶ **The bio is limited to 150 characters**
- ▶ Your bio should answer 2 main questions:
 - **What is this account?**
 - **Why should people follow me?**
- Things you can write about in your bio:
 - what are your credentials?
 - why are you different?
 - what's your general outlook on anything?
 - how often do you post?
- ▶ Check out other people's bios and see what they write

CTAs and links



Covered in this lecture:

What to put as your link

- ▶ Instagram only lets you put one clickable link on your profile, and that's in your bio
- **You need to use the last line of your bio to convince people to click your link**
- ▶ Highlight what they will get if they click it
- ▶ Use a down arrow emoji to point to the link
- ▶ Use a link that's relevant to what you're doing.
You could link to:
 - your homepage - will get you traffic
 - a lead magnet - will get you email addresses
 - a product that you sell - will get you revenue
- ▶ Examples:
 - Want to do something? Here's how:
 - Join ____ and get ____
 - I accomplished ____ Learn about it here/Get it here

Instagram Insights & Iconosquare



Covered in this lecture:

Setting up analytics

- ▶ Analytics are important because we want to know specifically how our audience performs - general Instagram stats are not very relevant
- **Free version: use the analytics/insights embedded in Instagram - it only works if you are a business account**
- ▶ You have to create a Facebook page and connect it to your IG account
- **Paid version: Iconosquare (\$7/month)**
- ▶ You will be able to see how many followers you get, how many you lose, which posts performed the best, best times to post, audience demographics, etc.
- ▶ You can respond to comments inside the app
- ▶ You can track competitors
- Set up your analytics before you start posting so you can better adapt your content to your audience over time

Protecting your account



Covered in this lecture:

Protecting your account from being stolen

- ▶ Unfortunately, Instagram theft happens quite often
- ▶ When you sign up for your main account, use a different email address than what you usually use
- ▶ Use a password manager (example: 1password.com). On Android, you can save your password
- **Connect your Facebook to your Instagram**
- ▶ If you lose your account but it's attached to your Facebook, it's much easier to get it back by proving who you are